



Security Training for Seafarers (STSDSD)

170 Practice Questions and Answers for STCW Exams

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Practice Set 1

Q1. One can ensure structural security by:

- A) Sealing off the ship
- B) Limiting Access Points
- C) Locking all doors
- D) Limiting entry into the ship

Correct Answer: B (Limiting Access Points)

Explanation: Structural security is enhanced by physical measures that restrict unauthorized movement. Limiting access points allows the crew to better monitor and control entries, significantly reducing the risk of unauthorized boarding or intrusion.

Q2. The port facility is required to appoint:

- A) Company Security Officer
- B) Port Facility Security Officer
- C) Ship Security Officer
- D) Port Facility Security Assessment (PFSA)

Correct Answer: B (Port Facility Security Officer)

Explanation: The ISPS Code mandates that every port facility must appoint a Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO). This individual is responsible for the development, implementation, and maintenance of the Port Facility Security Plan.

Q3. The term "security level" refers to:

- A) The degree of risk that a security incident will occur
- B) The level of casualties
- C) The level of danger
- D) The probability of an attack

Correct Answer: A (The degree of risk that a security incident will occur)

Explanation: Security levels, ranging from 1 to 3, quantify the risk of a security incident. Level 1 is normal, Level 2 indicates an elevated risk, and Level 3 represents the highest risk when an incident is probable or imminent.

Q4. Controlling embarkation of persons and their effects is done by:

- A) Visitor control, personal effects, and body searches
- B) Baggage control, personal effects, and body searches
- C) Access control, personal effects, and body searches
- D) CCTV control, personal effects, and baggage control

Correct Answer: C (Access control, personal effects, and body searches)

Explanation: Access control is the primary method for maintaining ship security. It involves verifying the identity of personnel and



Q5. To prevent a pirate attack, the first line of defense is:

- A) Proper lookout
- B) Maximize the speed of your vessel
- C) Seal all entrances to accommodation
- D) Early detection

Correct Answer: D (Early detection)

Explanation: Early detection is the most vital defensive layer in maritime security against piracy. By identifying potential threats from a distance, the crew gains sufficient time to maneuver, increase speed, and initiate other protective measures.

Q6. IMO introduced the ISPS Code and made it mandatory to enhance security in:

- A) July 2004
- B) December 2002
- C) July 1998
- D) After the 9/11 incident

Correct Answer: A (July 2004)

Explanation: The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code was adopted by the IMO as a direct response to the heightened global security concerns following the 9/11 incident, becoming mandatory in July 2004.

Q7. To meet the requirements of the ISPS Code, the most effective and practical methods used by port authorities for surveillance is:

- A) Dedicated task force to bolster security
- B) Use of security cameras
- C) Use of thermal cameras
- D) Trained security staff

Correct Answer: B (Use of security cameras)

Explanation: Security cameras (CCTV) are a cost-effective and continuous surveillance method required by the ISPS Code. They allow for monitoring of restricted areas and access points, providing a visual deterrent and an audit trail of activity.

Q8. Security equipment and systems need not be:

- A) Calibrated and tested before every use
- B) Kept under lock and key
- C) Tried out during each security drill
- D) Included in your pre-maintenance schedule (VMS)

Correct Answer: B (Kept under lock and key)

Explanation: Security equipment must be readily available when needed; therefore, it should be stored securely but accessible to authorized personnel. Keeping them under lock and key prevents tampering and ensures the gear is ready for use during a security threat.

Q9. Ship Security Assessments are the responsibility of:

- A) PFSO
- B) SSO
- C) Designated person
- D) CSO (Company Security Officer)

Correct Answer: D (CSO (Company Security Officer))



Q10. The use of water spray and foam monitors to deliver jets of water on an attacking skiff is intended to:

- A) Deter the attackers
- B) Disable their weapons
- C) Create a distraction
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Water monitors are non-lethal, effective deterrents against pirate skiffs. They are used to create a physical barrier of water, hamper the visibility and maneuverability of the attackers, and protect the vessel's hull from boarding.

Q11. A security alert should be issued:

- A) Immediately upon detection of a security threat
- B) Only after confirming the threat
- C) When the ship is in territorial waters
- D) At the discretion of the Master

Correct Answer: A (Immediately upon detection of a security threat)

Explanation: Prompt action is critical to maritime security. An alert must be issued immediately upon the detection of a threat to activate the ship's security protocols and ensure all crew members are warned and move to safety.

Q12. The person ultimately responsible for the security of the ship is:

- A) The Master
- B) The Chief Officer
- C) The Security Officer
- D) The Company Security Officer

Correct Answer: A (The Master)

Explanation: While security officers handle the technical implementation of security plans, the Master retains the ultimate authority and responsibility for the ship, its cargo, and the safety of all personnel on board.

Q13. Security drills should be conducted:

- A) Monthly
- B) Quarterly
- C) Annually
- D) As per the Ship Security Plan (SSP)

Correct Answer: D (As per the Ship Security Plan (SSP))

Explanation: Security drills and exercises must be conducted at regular intervals as specified in the ship's security plan to ensure the crew is proficient in executing security procedures and responding to different alert levels.

Q14. A security breach investigation should include:

- A) Interviews with witnesses
- B) Examination of evidence
- C) Review of security procedures
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: A thorough security investigation is essential to prevent recurrence. It requires a holistic review of what occurred,



Q15. The Designated Security Duties (DSD) officer is responsible for:

- A) Implementing the Ship Security Plan (SSP)
- B) Conducting security drills
- C) Investigating security breaches
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Seafarers assigned Designated Security Duties (DSD) are integral to maintaining ship security. Their responsibilities, as outlined in the ISPS Code and STCW, encompass active implementation of the SSP, conducting security drills, and assisting the SSO in investigating security incidents. Therefore, all listed activities fall within their remit.

Q16. Corrective actions should be taken when:

- A) A security incident occurs
- B) A security drill is not conducted as planned
- C) A vulnerability in the security system is identified
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Corrective actions are crucial for an effective Ship Security Plan (SSP) and overall maritime security. They are required proactively when vulnerabilities are identified, reactively after a security incident, and when scheduled security drills or exercises are not performed as planned, ensuring continuous improvement and compliance with ISPS Code.

Q17. Actions which are not necessarily part of an assessment of a security drill include:

- A) Debriefing by Master and SSO
- B) Disciplinary action against any crew member
- C) Analysis and discussions on takeaways from drills
- D) Written report of the drill

Correct Answer: B (Disciplinary action against any crew member)

Explanation: The assessment of a security drill, as per the ISPS Code, focuses on evaluating performance, identifying deficiencies, and improving the Ship Security Plan (SSP). It involves debriefing, analysis, and a written report. Disciplinary action is generally not an immediate or necessary part of the drill assessment process itself, which is for learning and improvement.

Q18. Overt methods to overcome security measures include:

- A) Forcefully breaking and entering
- B) Disabling alarms
- C) While the guards are sleeping
- D) Befriending the crew members

Correct Answer: A (Forcefully breaking and entering)

Explanation: Overt methods to overcome security measures are those that are open, observable, and often involve direct confrontation or visible force. Forcefully breaking and entering is a clear example of an overt act, as it directly and visibly challenges physical security barriers. Other options generally describe covert or subtle approaches.



- A) CSO
- B) SSO
- C) Master
- D) Chief Officer

Correct Answer: C (Master)

Explanation: The Declaration of Security (DoS) is a critical document under the ISPS Code, establishing shared security responsibilities between a ship and a port facility. It is signed by the Master of the ship and the Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO), as the Master holds ultimate authority and responsibility for the ship's operations and security.

Q20. The Global Integrated Shipping Information System (GIS) is accessible to:

- A) IMO members
- B) International Maritime Bureau
- C) Contracting governments
- D) Ship owners

Correct Answer: A (IMO members)

Explanation: The Global Integrated Shipping Information System (GIS) is an IMO platform designed to provide restricted access to various maritime data. Its primary users and those with comprehensive access include IMO member states and related organizations for regulatory and enforcement purposes, supporting the implementation of international conventions.

Q21. Security measures are not necessarily extended by the contracting governments for:

- A) Offshore supply vessels (OSVs)
- B) Fishing vessels
- C) Passenger and cargo ships in coastal trade
- D) Naval vessels

Correct Answer: B (Fishing vessels)

Explanation: The ISPS Code primarily applies to passenger ships, cargo ships over 500 gross tonnage, and mobile offshore drilling units engaged on international voyages. Fishing vessels are generally excluded from the mandatory provisions of the ISPS Code, although some national regulations might impose security measures.

Q22. To ensure ship's personnel are doing their security duties properly, one must carry out:

- A) Continuous survey
- B) On-scene security survey
- C) Intermediate survey
- D) Surprise survey

Correct Answer: D (Surprise survey)

Explanation: To effectively verify that ship's personnel are performing their security duties correctly and consistently, surprise surveys or inspections are often employed. This method provides an unannounced assessment of adherence to the Ship Security Plan (SSP) and ISPS Code procedures, revealing actual operational practices rather than prepared demonstrations.

Q23. If a suspicious object or package is found on board, the first action should be to:

- A) Activate radio communication
- B) Seize and open the package
- C) Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item
- D) Inform the person of your suspicion

Correct Answer: C (Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item)



Q24. The protection of people is called:

- A) Ship security
- B) Human security
- C) Crew security
- D) Physical security

Correct Answer: D (Physical security)

Explanation: In the context of security measures like those under the ISPS Code, "physical security" specifically refers to the protection of personnel, assets, and facilities from unauthorized access, damage, or harm. This includes controlling access, surveillance, and protective barriers for people on board, as opposed to broader concepts like human security.

Q25. Security equipment and systems disallowed for use on board include:

- A) Locking equipment for all external doors
- B) Firearms
- C) Razor wire and bar fence wires
- D) Searchlights

Correct Answer: B (Firearms)

Explanation: Under international maritime law and the ISPS Code, commercial vessels are generally prohibited from carrying firearms, except in very specific circumstances with explicit authorization from the Flag State and coastal states. Other items like locks, razor wire (with proper precautions), and searchlights are commonly used security enhancements.

Q26. The mandatory requirements of the ISPS Code are contained in:

- A) Conference resolutions
- B) Part A
- C) Part B
- D) Introduction

Correct Answer: B (Part A)

Explanation: The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code is divided into two parts. Part A contains the mandatory requirements, including those for Ship Security Plans (SSP) and Port Facility Security Plans (PFSP). Part B provides non-mandatory guidance for the implementation of these requirements.

Q27. Complaints of security incidents on board do not require:

- A) Periodic testing of communication equipment
- B) Ship Security Plan to be displayed
- C) Immediate investigation
- D) Reporting to the port facility

Correct Answer: C (Immediate investigation)

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan (SSP) contains sensitive information regarding the ship's security arrangements and vulnerabilities, as per the ISPS Code. It is a confidential document that should only be accessible to authorized personnel and is explicitly not to be displayed openly on board, ensuring its integrity and effectiveness.



- A) Activate radio communication
- B) Seize and open the package
- C) Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item
- D) Inform the person of your suspicion

Correct Answer: C (Cordon and control the area around the suspicious item)

Explanation: When a suspicious object is found, the immediate priority, as per ship security procedures, is to ensure safety and prevent potential harm. Cordoning off and controlling the area isolates the threat and allows for further assessment by qualified personnel, following the Ship Security Plan (SSP) protocols.

Q29. The protection of people is called:

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- C) Crew security
- D) Physical security

Correct Answer: D (Physical security)

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Explanation: Under international maritime law and the ISPS Code, commercial vessels are generally prohibited from carrying firearms, except in very specific circumstances with explicit authorization from the Flag State and coastal states. Other items like locks, razor wire (with proper precautions), and searchlights are commonly used security enhancements.

Practice Set 2

Q1. Who issues the CSR (Continuous Synopsis Record)?

- A) Classification Society
- B) Port State Control
- C) Flag State
- D) Company Security Officer

Correct Answer: C (Flag State)

Explanation: The Continuous Synopsis Record (CSR) is an essential onboard document under SOLAS Chapter XI-1/5, providing a history of the ship. It is issued by the Flag State of the vessel and contains vital information such as the ship's name, flag, IMO number, and details of ownership and management, updated throughout its operational life.



- A) Must be locked from the inside at all times
- B) Must be capable of opening from the direction for which escape is required
- C) Can only be opened using a master key
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (Must be capable of opening from the direction for which escape is required)

Explanation: Escape routes, particularly their openings, must always be readily accessible and operable to ensure the safe and rapid evacuation of personnel during an emergency, including security incidents. The SOLAS convention and ship safety regulations mandate that such openings are capable of being opened from the direction of escape without special tools.

Q3. What is the operational limitation of security equipment like a weld lock?

- A) It can easily fail due to high vibrations
- B) The weld locks can be cut open
- C) It cannot withstand marine corrosion
- D) It can only be operated electronically

Correct Answer: B (The weld locks can be cut open)

Explanation: While weld locks offer a degree of physical security, their primary operational limitation lies in their vulnerability to determined intruders with appropriate tools. Weld locks, like other physical barriers, can be cut, ground, or broken open using specialized equipment, thereby compromising their protective function.

Q4. Who is responsible for the regular security inspections of the ship?

- A) Company Security Officer (CSO)
- B) Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO)
- C) Ship Security Officer (SSO)
- D) The Chief Engineer

Correct Answer: C (Ship Security Officer (SSO))

Explanation: The Ship Security Officer (SSO), as defined by the ISPS Code, is directly responsible for the security of the ship. This includes conducting regular security inspections of the ship, ensuring the implementation and maintenance of the Ship Security Plan (SSP), and overseeing the training of shipboard personnel.

Q5. Which of the following is considered an assessment tool?

- A) Fuel oil consumption log
- B) Open deck arrangement including the height of the deck above water
- C) Official Log Book entries
- D) Cargo manifest list

Correct Answer: B (Open deck arrangement including the height of the deck above water)

Explanation: In the context of a Ship Security Assessment (SSA), understanding the ship's physical layout, such as open deck arrangements and deck height, is crucial. This information helps identify potential vulnerabilities for unauthorized access (e.g., from small boats) and aids in developing effective countermeasures as part of the Ship Security Plan (SSP).

Q6. Before hiding in the safe house or Citadel, we shall:

- A) Keep the main engine on standby
- B) Stop and immobilize the main engine
- C) Increase ventilation to the maximum
- D) Turn on all deck floodlights

Correct Answer: B (Stop and immobilize the main engine)



Q7. To ensure shipboard personnel are ready to deal with different security situations, what should you carry out?

- A) Theoretical lectures only
- B) Drills and exercises
- C) Tabletop reviews exclusively
- D) Maintenance check sheets

Correct Answer: B (Drills and exercises)

Explanation: As mandated by the ISPS Code and STCW Convention, regular security drills and exercises are essential to ensure shipboard personnel are competent and prepared to respond effectively to various security threats. They provide practical experience, reinforce theoretical knowledge, and test the efficacy of the Ship Security Plan (SSP).

Q8. A security drill can be conducted in:

- A) Isolation without any crew involvement
- B) Combination with other exercises such as emergency response exercises
- C) Only when the vessel is drydocked
- D) Only under the supervision of a Port State surveyor

Correct Answer: B (Combination with other exercises such as emergency response exercises)

Explanation: Security drills, as per ISPS Code guidelines, can often be combined with other mandatory drills, such as fire or abandon ship exercises, provided that the security aspects are adequately addressed. This integrated approach optimizes training time and enhances crew readiness for complex emergency scenarios.

Q9. What can be a possible smuggling mode on a ship?

- A) Via the automated ballast system
- B) By the routine suppliers
- C) Through the main engine exhaust trunk
- D) Via satellite communication links

Correct Answer: B (By the routine suppliers)

Explanation: Routine suppliers, such as those delivering stores, provisions, or spare parts, present a significant vulnerability for smuggling on board ships. Without stringent access control and thorough checks of all incoming goods, contraband can easily be introduced onto the vessel, circumventing security measures.

Q10. Which of the following is considered an assessment tool?

- A) Vessel stable parameters
- B) Existing personnel identification documents
- C) Engine room logbook profile
- D) Crew list visa applications

Correct Answer: B (Existing personnel identification documents)

Explanation: In a Ship Security Assessment (SSA), evaluating the existing personnel identification documents and procedures is a key assessment tool. It helps identify vulnerabilities related to identity verification, access control, and the potential for unauthorized individuals to board or remain on the ship, as required by the ISPS Code.



- Q11. The RSO (Recognized Security Organization) can carry out which of the following for a company or ship?**
- A) Approving the permanent flag changes
 - B) Ship Security Assessment (SSA)
 - C) Commercial cargo custom checks
 - D) Crew medical clearance

Correct Answer: B (Ship Security Assessment (SSA))

Explanation: A Recognized Security Organization (RSO) is authorized by a Contracting Government to conduct Ship Security Assessments (SSA) and review and approve Ship Security Plans (SSP) on its behalf, as per the ISPS Code. RSOs play a crucial role in ensuring compliance and enhancing maritime security.

Q12. Which of the below spaces on deck and machinery spaces are most vulnerable for smuggling of drugs and contrabands?

- A) Main steering flat floor
- B) Equipment box
- C) Generator platform railings
- D) Purifier room workbench

Correct Answer: B (Equipment box)

Explanation: Equipment boxes and other storage containers on deck or in machinery spaces are highly vulnerable for smuggling drugs and contraband due to their potential for concealment and relatively easy access. Regular and thorough security searches, as part of the Ship Security Plan (SSP), must target such areas.

Q13. Who appoints the PFSO (Port Facility Security Officer) for a port?

- A) Shipping Company
- B) Government
- C) The Ship Master
- D) Classification Society

Correct Answer: B (Government)

Explanation: The Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO) is a crucial role under the ISPS Code, responsible for the development, implementation, and maintenance of the Port Facility Security Plan (PFSP). PFSOs are appointed by the relevant Contracting Government or the designated authority for the port facility.

Q14. Which of the following spaces in the Galley and dry stores are *least* vulnerable for smuggling of drugs and contrabands?

- A) Inside bulk flour bins
- B) In the galley first aid box
- C) Behind walk-in freezer panels
- D) Under dry store floorboards

Correct Answer: B (In the galley first aid box)

Explanation: The galley first aid box is generally the least vulnerable among the options for smuggling large quantities of drugs or contraband. While not immune, its small size and frequent use for medical items make it less practical for clandestine storage compared to hidden compartments in bulk stores or behind panels.



- A) Full machinery maintenance layout
- B) A description of countermeasures that could be used to address vulnerability
- C) Crew wage scales and financial portfolios
- D) Commercial routing preferences

Correct Answer: B (A description of countermeasures that could be used to address vulnerability)

Explanation: The Ship Security Assessment (SSA) report, mandated by the ISPS Code, identifies vulnerabilities and outlines potential countermeasures. It includes an on-scene survey, an analysis of threats and vulnerabilities, and a description of protective measures, personnel, procedures, and equipment that could mitigate identified risks.

Q16. A DoS (Declaration of Security) is required when:

- A) The ship is entering a dry dock area
- B) When port and ship are not on the same security level
- C) A crew member changes their contract status
- D) Bunkering operation is completed safely

Correct Answer: B (When port and ship are not on the same security level)

Explanation: A Declaration of Security (DoS) is typically required under the ISPS Code when a ship is interfacing with a port facility or another ship, and one party is at a higher security level than the other. It ensures that appropriate security measures are agreed upon and maintained to address the heightened risk.

Q17. Who is responsible for the submission of the Ship Security Plan (SSP) for approval?

- A) Ship Security Officer (SSO)
- B) Company Security Officer (CSO)
- C) Master of the Vessel
- D) Port Facility Security Officer

Correct Answer: B (Company Security Officer (CSO))

Explanation: The Company Security Officer (CSO), appointed by the shipping company, is responsible for ensuring that a Ship Security Assessment (SSA) is carried out and that a Ship Security Plan (SSP) is developed, submitted for approval to the Flag State or RSO, and subsequently implemented and maintained on board.

Q18. Who approves the Ship Security Plan?

- A) The Port Authority
- B) The Flag State
- C) The Recognized Cargo Agency
- D) Charterer's Representative

Correct Answer: B (The Flag State)

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan (SSP), a critical document under the ISPS Code, must be approved by the Flag State Administration or a Recognized Security Organization (RSO) acting on its behalf. This approval ensures that the plan meets the mandatory requirements and effectively addresses the identified security vulnerabilities of the ship.

Q19. Security level means the qualification of the degree of protection.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: A (True)

Explanation: True. "Security level" as defined in the ISPS Code, refers to the degree of risk that a security incident will occur. It indicates the level of vigilance and the corresponding protective measures that must be implemented by ships and port facilities to



Q20. Seafarers with designated security duties are responsible for:

- A) Comprehensive engine overhauling procedures
- B) Knowledge of methods of physical structures of baggage
- C) Managing commercial port bills
- D) Calculating vessel stability indices

Correct Answer: B (Knowledge of methods of physical structures of baggage)

Explanation: Seafarers assigned Designated Security Duties (DSD), as per STCW and ISPS Code, receive training in critical security functions. This includes understanding search techniques, methods for inspecting baggage and cargo, and identifying suspicious items or concealed compartments, directly related to the physical integrity of the vessel.

Q21. The ISPS code applies to:

- A) Cargo ships
- B) Passenger ships
- C) Ships above 500 GRT
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code, specifically SOLAS Chapter XI-2, applies broadly to passenger ships, cargo ships (including high-speed craft) of 500 gross tonnage and upwards, and mobile offshore drilling units, when engaged on international voyages. It also applies to port facilities serving such ships.

Q22. Which of the following is considered a security record?

- A) Engine indicator cards
- B) Record of security/safety drills
- C) Cargo stowage plan blueprints
- D) Fuel oil analysis profiles

Correct Answer: B (Record of security/safety drills)

Explanation: Under the ISPS Code, records of security drills and exercises are mandatory security records. They demonstrate compliance, document training, and provide evidence of the ship's preparedness to respond to security threats, forming a crucial part of the Ship Security Plan (SSP) documentation.

Q23. A DoS is required when a ship-port interface poses a significant pollution risk.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: Pollution and security have no technical relevance under ISPS context

Q24. Which of the below is *not* included in a CSR (Continuous Synopsis Record)?

- A) Flag under which ship is registered
- B) The SSO's name
- C) Date of ship registration
- D) Name of the classification society

Correct Answer: B (The SSO's name)

Explanation: The Continuous Synopsis Record (CSR), mandated by SOLAS, contains a permanent record of the ship's history, including flag, name, IMO number, owner, and classification society. While the SSO is a critical security role, their personal name is



Q25. Who sets the security level for the ship?

- A) The Charterer
- B) The Flag State
- C) The Chief Mate
- D) The Port Customs Department

Correct Answer: B (The Flag State)

Explanation: The security level for a ship is primarily set by the Contracting Government (Flag State) or, when in port, by the Port State. The ship's Company Security Officer (CSO) and Ship Security Officer (SSO) must ensure the vessel operates at the declared security level, adjusting measures as required by the Ship Security Plan (SSP).

Q26. Complete the sentence: Security drills should be conducted at least once every:

- A) One month
- B) Three months
- C) Six months
- D) Twelve months

Correct Answer: B (Three months)

Explanation: As per the ISPS Code, security drills should be conducted at intervals of no more than three months. This regular practice ensures that shipboard personnel are proficient in their security duties and familiar with the Ship Security Plan (SSP), maintaining a high level of preparedness for various security scenarios.

Q27. Which of the below spaces on deck and machinery spaces are most vulnerable for smuggling of drugs or contraband?

- A) Captain's office desk
- B) Cargo hold
- C) Galley mess room tables
- D) Navigation bridge deck floors

Correct Answer: B (Cargo hold)

Explanation: Cargo holds, due to their large volume and often varying access control during loading and unloading, are highly vulnerable spaces for the concealment and smuggling of drugs or contraband. Comprehensive search procedures and stringent access control are essential for these areas, as outlined in the Ship Security Plan (SSP).

Q28. The modern definition of piracy includes one of the following:

- A) Commercial contract breach
- B) Robbery
- C) Unintentional navigational deviation
- D) Cargo short delivery disputes

Correct Answer: B (Robbery)

Explanation: Under international law (UNCLOS Article 101), piracy involves illegal acts of violence or detention committed for private ends by the crew or passengers of a private ship or aircraft against another ship or aircraft on the high seas. This definition directly encompasses acts of robbery at sea.



Q29. You find a suspicious object on the deck. Which action will you take?

- A) Throw it overboard immediately
- B) Inform Master immediately on radio
- C) Open it up to check the contents yourself
- D) Leave it and check it during the next watch change

Correct Answer: B (Inform Master immediately on radio)

Explanation: Discovering a suspicious object requires immediate action and adherence to the Ship Security Plan (SSP). The priority is to inform the Master immediately, who will then assess the situation and initiate appropriate responses, which may include isolating the area and calling for expert assistance. Unauthorized handling is dangerous.

Q30. Which of the below spaces in the galley and dry stores are most vulnerable for smuggling and contrabands?

- A) Daily dry store shelves
- B) Inside fish or sides of beef in freezers
- C) The mess room dining counter
- D) Open garbage bin containers

Correct Answer: B (Inside fish or sides of beef in freezers)

Explanation: In the galley and dry stores, concealed spaces within perishable goods like large fish or sides of beef in freezers present a significant vulnerability for smuggling. Such items require thorough inspection, as contraband can be hidden within them, making detection difficult without careful scrutiny during loading and storage.

Practice Set 3

Q1. Which of the below has the *least* possibility of finding hidden drugs and contrabands?

- A) In the wash basin cabinet
- B) On the soap stand
- C) All the above
- D) Inside structural ventilation louvers

Correct Answer: C (All the above)

Explanation: Least likely context compared to hidden voids

Q2. The CSR is a:

- A) Commercial Statement of Freight Rates
- B) Record of history of the ship
- C) Crew Service Record registry
- D) Custom Survey Report

Correct Answer: B (Record of history of the ship)

Explanation: The Continuous Synopsis Record (CSR), mandated by SOLAS Chapter XI-1/5, serves as a comprehensive onboard history of the ship. It records essential administrative data, such as the ship's name, flag, owner, and management, detailing all changes throughout its operational life to enhance transparency and security.



- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: A (True)

Explanation: True. The Ship Security Plan (SSP), as per the ISPS Code, is a comprehensive document designed to protect all aspects of the vessel - including personnel, cargo, transport units, ship's stores, and the ship itself - from potential security incidents and threats. Its scope is all-encompassing.

Q4. The ISPS code applies to cargo ships, passenger ships, and:

- A) Non-propelled wooden barges
- B) Mobile offshore drilling units (MODUs)
- C) Pleasure yachts under 12 meters
- D) Coastal fishing boats

Correct Answer: B (Mobile offshore drilling units (MODUs))

Explanation: Or D - All the Above based on video options sequence

Q5. Which of the following equipment is *not* a part of cyber security?

- A) Firewalls
- B) Soap up equipment
- C) Encryption devices
- D) Network routers

Correct Answer: B (Soap up equipment)

Explanation: Firewalls, encryption devices, and network routers are all fundamental components of cyber security infrastructure, designed to protect digital systems and data from unauthorized access or attacks. "Soap up equipment" is not a recognized term in cybersecurity and is therefore not part of cyber security measures.

Q6. Which of the following is considered an assessment tool?

- A) Main bilge piping blueprint
- B) Location and function of each actual or potential access point to the ship
- C) Bunkering delivery ticket sequences
- D) Hydrostatic curve registers

Correct Answer: B (Location and function of each actual or potential access point to the ship)

Explanation: In a Ship Security Assessment (SSA), identifying and analyzing all actual and potential access points to the ship is a critical assessment tool. This detailed understanding allows for the evaluation of vulnerabilities and the development of effective access control measures, as required by the ISPS Code.

Q7. When doing a physical search of a package or bag, we should look for the following:

- A) Price tags of the items
- B) The quality of the package or bag
- C) Manufacturer addresses
- D) Expiry dates of interior goods

Correct Answer: B (The quality of the package or bag)

Explanation: During a physical search of a package or bag for security purposes, personnel should pay attention to the construction and quality of the item itself. Unusual or poor quality, tampering, false bottoms, or unusual weight distribution can indicate concealment or attempts to bypass security, guiding further investigation.



- A) Open walkways
- B) Cofferdams
- C) Steering wheel housing
- D) Main switchboard panels

Correct Answer: B (Cofferdams)

Explanation: Cofferdams are enclosed, often inaccessible spaces designed to provide separation, making them ideal clandestine hiding spots for contraband due to their infrequent inspection and isolation. Open walkways, steering wheel housing, and main switchboard panels are more visible or require specialist access, making them less preferred for illicit concealment.

Q9. A DoS is required when:

- A) When a ship interfaces with a non-ISPS compliant ship
- B) When the vessel drops anchor in open international waters
- C) The crew complements change fully
- D) When taking provisions from a standard certified barge

Correct Answer: A (When a ship interfaces with a non-ISPS compliant ship)

Explanation: A Declaration of Security (DoS) is an agreement between a ship and a port facility, or between two ships, specifying the security measures each will implement. It is required when a ship is operating at a higher security level than the port facility or another ship, or when interfacing with a non-ISPS compliant entity to ensure necessary security protocols are met.

Q10. When the Ship Security Alert System (SSAS) is activated, the alarm will sound:

- A) On nearby vessels
- B) On one's own ship
- C) In the ship's engine room
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: D (None of the above)

Explanation: It is a covert alarm transmitted directly to shore

Q11. The most vulnerable place in a cabin where we can find hidden drugs and contrabands is:

- A) Open book shelves
- B) Inside radio or TV
- C) Top of the study desk
- D) The main wardrobe hanger rod

Correct Answer: B (Inside radio or TV)

Explanation: Electronic equipment like radios or TVs offer concealed spaces behind their casings, making them prime locations for stashing small, illicit items. Open book shelves, study desks, and wardrobe hanger rods are easily visible and frequently accessed, thus less suitable for discrete concealment.

Q12. Which of the following may be used as additional security measures?

- A) Turning off all navigational radars
- B) Pressurized fire hoses on deck
- C) Closing sea chests entirely
- D) Isolating the emergency generator emergency link

Correct Answer: B (Pressurized fire hoses on deck)

Explanation: Pressurized fire hoses on deck can serve as a non-lethal deterrent against unauthorized boarding attempts, creating a



Q13. The best place to search individuals physically is:

- A) In the engine room workshop
- B) Near the gangway
- C) On the captain's bridge deck
- D) Inside the steering flat

Correct Answer: B (Near the gangway)

Explanation: The gangway is the primary point of access to the vessel, making it the most effective and logical location for physical searches of individuals before they can gain significant access to the ship. Conducting searches elsewhere would mean unauthorized persons have already boarded.

Q14. The normal level that the ship or port facility operates on a daily basis is:

- A) Security level 1
- B) Security level 2
- C) Security level 3
- D) Security level 0

Correct Answer: A (Security level 1)

Explanation: Security Level 1 is the normal level at which ships and port facilities operate, ensuring minimum appropriate protective security measures are maintained at all times. Higher levels (2 and 3) are set when there is an increased risk or imminent threat of a security incident.

Q15. Which of the following are *not* regular security measures implemented at security level 1?

- A) Controlling access to the ship
- B) Call for shore security personnel
- C) Supervising the handling of cargo
- D) Ensuring security communication is available

Correct Answer: B (Call for shore security personnel)

Explanation: Calling for shore security personnel is typically a heightened measure, often reserved for Security Level 2 or 3, when existing shipboard security capabilities are insufficient. Controlling access, supervising cargo handling, and ensuring communication availability are standard, regular measures at Security Level 1.

Q16. For security level 3:

- A) Normal watchkeeping ranks are reduced
- B) Additional group to be put on security duty
- C) All shore leave is standardly granted
- D) Cargo handling is speeded up to maximum limits

Correct Answer: B (Additional group to be put on security duty)

Explanation: Security Level 3 signifies an imminent or actual security incident, requiring further specific protective measures, which includes deploying additional personnel for security duties to respond effectively. Reducing watchkeeping ranks, granting shore leave, or speeding up cargo are contrary to heightened security protocols.



Q17. How frequently shall the Master review the Ship Security Plan (SSP)?

- A) Monthly
- B) Quarterly
- C) Annually
- D) Bi-annually

Correct Answer: B (Quarterly)

Explanation: While formal external audits are typically annual, the Master (as SSO) is expected to frequently review the SSP's operational effectiveness. Quarterly internal checks ensure the SSP remains current with evolving threats and operational changes, preventing complacency and ensuring constant readiness, as advised by best practices.

Q18. Which of the following is considered an assessment tool?

- A) Identification of additional areas which should be secured
- B) Daily engine fuel log sheet
- C) Propeller slip coefficients
- D) Refrigeration gas charging manuals

Correct Answer: B (Daily engine fuel log sheet)

Explanation: A daily engine fuel log sheet is an assessment tool for monitoring and evaluating ship operational parameters, such as fuel consumption and engine performance. While not a direct security assessment tool, such records provide data that can be assessed for anomalies, which might indirectly indicate unusual activity or system deviations relevant to broader ship integrity.

Q19. Which of the following equipment is a part of cyber security?

- A) Mechanical sound-powered phones
- B) Dedicated cargo computers
- C) Hydraulic valve remote control levers
- D) Main engine indicator mechanical drums

Correct Answer: B (Dedicated cargo computers)

Explanation: Dedicated cargo computers, often networked and critical for cargo operations and administration, are integral to a ship's IT infrastructure and thus fall under cyber security considerations. Mechanical sound-powered phones, hydraulic levers, and engine indicator drums are purely mechanical or analogue systems, not susceptible to cyber threats.

Q20. Who approves the permanent revisions of the Ship Security Plan?

- A) Local Port Authority
- B) The Flag State
- C) Chief Security Agency of the Port
- D) The Classification surveyor exclusively

Correct Answer: B (The Flag State)

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan (SSP) is approved by the Administration (Flag State) or a Recognized Security Organization (RSO) acting on its behalf. Any permanent revisions or major amendments to the SSP must be submitted for re-approval to the Flag State to ensure continued compliance with the ISPS Code.

Q21. Can the ship be at a *lower* security level than the port it is interfacing with?

- A) Yes
- B) No

Correct Answer: B (No)

Explanation: Under the ISPS Code, a ship's security level must always be at least equal to, or higher than, the security level of the port facility it is interfacing with. This ensures that the vessel maintains an adequate level of security posture to address any potential



Q22. Who proposes modifications to the Ship Security Plan?

- A) Port Facility Security Officer
- B) Company Security Officer
- C) Third Mate
- D) Custom Agent

Correct Answer: B (Company Security Officer)

Explanation: The Company Security Officer (CSO) is primarily responsible for ensuring the Ship Security Assessment (SSA) is carried out, that a Ship Security Plan (SSP) is developed and maintained, and for proposing any necessary modifications to the SSP based on security assessments, audits, or changes in operational circumstances.

Q23. Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO) means a person tasked to:

- A) Manage standard cargo commercial operations
- B) Manage Port Security
- C) Inspect marine auxiliary machinery ashore
- D) Handle ship-to-shore bunkering pipelines financially

Correct Answer: B (Manage Port Security)

Explanation: The Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO) is responsible for the development, implementation, revision, and maintenance of the Port Facility Security Plan (PFSP), and for liaison with Ship Security Officers (SSOs) and Company Security Officers (CSOs) regarding security matters. Their primary role is to manage and oversee port security.

Q24. Who sets the maritime security level for a country's territorial waters?

- A) Ship Master
- B) Flag State Authority
- C) Private Maritime Security Agency
- D) Classification Board

Correct Answer: B (Flag State Authority)

Explanation: The Contracting Government (Flag State Authority or Coastal State Authority) is responsible for setting the appropriate maritime security level for its ports and territorial waters, communicating this to ships and port facilities within its jurisdiction.

Q25. Is security fencing mandatory for the ship-side railing?

- A) Mandatory at all times
- B) Not mandatory
- C) Mandatory only during dry dock periods
- D) Dependent on structural class rules only

Correct Answer: B (Not mandatory)

Explanation: While additional physical barriers like fencing or barbed wire may be implemented as temporary security measures at higher security levels, a permanent security fence on the ship's railing is not a mandatory requirement under the ISPS Code. Ship design focuses on safety and operational functionality primarily.



- A) Technical Superintendent
- B) Company Security Officer (CSO)
- C) Crewing Manager
- D) Financial Director

Correct Answer: B (Company Security Officer (CSO))

Explanation: The Ship Security Officer (SSO) is the designated person on board responsible for the ship's security and for liaising with the Company Security Officer (CSO) and Port Facility Security Officers (PFSOs) on security matters, forming the crucial link in the ship-shore security interface.

Q27. What is the operational limitation of security equipment such as weld logs?

- A) Cannot be used on steel structures
- B) The weld logs can be cut open
- C) They require active high-voltage power
- D) High vulnerability to sea spray damage

Correct Answer: B (The weld logs can be cut open)

Explanation: Assuming "weld logs" refers to physical security barriers like weld locks or welded bars, their operational limitation is that they can be compromised. With sufficient time and tools, such as cutting equipment, even robust welded structures can be breached by determined intruders.

Q28. The ISPS code is **not** mandatory for Coastal Supply vessels.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: The ISPS Code applies to cargo ships of 500 gross tonnage and upwards, passenger ships, and mobile offshore drilling units engaged on international voyages. Coastal Supply vessels meeting these criteria or operating in environments requiring ISPS compliance would be subject to the Code, making the statement false.

Q29. The maximum validity of the International Ship Security Certificate (ISSC) is:

- A) 2 years
- B) 5 years
- C) 7 years
- D) 10 years

Correct Answer: B (5 years)

Explanation: An International Ship Security Certificate (ISSC) is issued for a period specified by the Administration, which shall not exceed five years. Its validity is subject to intermediate and renewal verification surveys to ensure ongoing compliance with the ISPS Code.

Q30. Which of the below spaces on deck and machinery spaces are most vulnerable for smuggling drugs and contrabands?

- A) Open main deck walkways
- B) Ventilation ducts
- C) Purifier drip trays
- D) Boiler burner platform surfaces

Correct Answer: B (Ventilation ducts)

Explanation: Ventilation ducts provide concealed and often extensive internal pathways, making them highly vulnerable for hiding



Practice Set 4

Q1. Which of the following are regular security measures implemented at security level 1?

- A) Suspend all operations immediately
- B) Supervise the handling of cargo and ship stores
- C) Search 100% of all packages manually
- D) Evacuate non-essential personnel to a Citadel

Correct Answer: B (Supervise the handling of cargo and ship stores)

Explanation: At Security Level 1, routine measures include supervising cargo and ship stores handling to prevent unauthorized access or introduction of contraband. Suspending operations, 100% manual package search, or evacuating personnel are elevated measures typically for Security Level 2 or 3.

Q2. When securing the Escape Route doors, can we lock them closed?

- A) Yes, to prevent unauthorized intrusion
- B) No
- C) Only during night port stays
- D) Yes, if authorized by the SSO verbally

Correct Answer: B (No)

Explanation: Escape route doors, vital for the safe evacuation of personnel in an emergency, must never be locked in a manner that prevents their immediate opening from the inside. Security measures must not compromise safety and emergency egress requirements under SOLAS.

Q3. An RSO (Recognized Security Organization) *cannot* do the following for a Contracting Government:

- A) Review ship security assessments
- B) Communicate with the ship or port on active security matters
- C) Conduct verification audits
- D) Issue interim certificates if authorized

Correct Answer: B (Communicate with the ship or port on active security matters)

Explanation: A Recognized Security Organization (RSO) can review security assessments, conduct verification audits, and issue certificates on behalf of the Administration. However, communicating with ships or ports on active security threat responses or setting security levels remains the responsibility of the Contracting Government or its designated authority, not an RSO.

Q4. Why is it advised to hide in the safe house or Citadel during a pirate attack?

- A) To keep up with routine paperwork safely
- B) To avoid being caught by the pirates and hence prevent them from taking control of the ship
- C) To protect machinery from overheating
- D) To avoid physical labor during a crisis

Correct Answer: B (To avoid being caught by the pirates and hence prevent them from taking control of the ship)

Explanation: The primary purpose of a Citadel or Safe Muster Point during a pirate attack is to provide a secure, impenetrable refuge for the crew. This prevents their capture, denies pirates access to the ship's vital controls, frustrates their objective, and buys time for rescue.



- A) Monthly
- B) Annually
- C) Every 3 years
- D) Every 5 years

Correct Answer: B (Annually)

Explanation: Company internal audits of the Ship Security Plan (SSP) and its implementation, along with the International Safety Management (ISM) Code audits, are generally conducted annually. This frequency ensures systematic review, identifies non-conformities, and allows for timely correction of deficiencies to maintain compliance and effectiveness.

Q6. The on-scene security survey does *not* fulfill the following function:

- A) Identifying existing security measures
- B) Identifying the ship's engine performance
- C) Evaluating shipboard key operations
- D) Determining weaknesses in physical security infrastructure

Correct Answer: B (Identifying the ship's engine performance)

Explanation: An on-scene security survey, which forms part of the Ship Security Assessment (SSA), focuses on identifying security measures, evaluating key operations, and determining weaknesses in physical security. It does not assess or identify the ship's engine performance, which falls under technical and operational assessments.

Q7. Amendment of an approved SSP does not involve a review of the ship's SSA.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: Any significant amendment or revision to an approved Ship Security Plan (SSP) generally necessitates a review of the Ship Security Assessment (SSA). This ensures the plan remains appropriate and effective in addressing current threats and vulnerabilities, making the statement false.

Q8. Where is the guidance for risk-based assessment available in the ISPS framework?

- A) ISPS Code Part A
- B) ISPS Code Part B
- C) Solas Chapter II-1
- D) MARPOL Annex VI

Correct Answer: B (ISPS Code Part B)

Explanation: Part B of the ISPS Code provides detailed guidance and recommendations for the implementation of the provisions of Chapter XI-2 of SOLAS and Part A of the Code. This includes comprehensive guidance for conducting ship and port facility security assessments on a risk-based approach.

Q9. Which of the following is considered a most vulnerable place where hidden drugs and contrabands can be found?

- A) Fire extinguishers
- B) Fire hose and compartments
- C) Access panels in floors, walls, and ceilings
- D) All of them

Correct Answer: D (All of them)

Explanation: All listed options-fire extinguishers, fire hose and compartments, and access panels in floors, walls, and ceilings-are



Q10. The most vulnerable place in toilets and showers where we can find hidden drugs and contrabands is:

- A) Open towel rails
- B) Behind and under the wash basin
- C) The shower curtain rod surface
- D) On top of exposed soap dishes

Correct Answer: B (Behind and under the wash basin)

Explanation: Areas behind and under wash basins, often with concealed piping and access panels, offer discreet spaces for hiding small items due to their less visible nature. Open towel rails, shower curtain rods, and exposed soap dishes are highly visible and unsuitable for covert concealment.

Q11. An ISSC (International Ship Security Certificate) can lose validity if the ship changes its operational management.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

*Explanation: An ISSC remains valid even if operational management changes, provided the ship's Company Security Officer (CSO) and the Company itself remain the same as listed on the certificate. A change in the *Company* (ownership/operator) would typically require re-certification.*

Q12. The SSAS activation locations must be known to all ship's crew.

- A) True
- B) False

Correct Answer: B (False)

Explanation: SSAS locations are kept confidential to prevent compromise by internal/external threats; only designated crew know them

Q13. Can a Port Authority deny entry to a ship from another country if it does not comply with the ISPS code?

- A) Yes
- B) No

Correct Answer: A (Yes)

Explanation: A Contracting Government, through its Port State Control, has the authority to take control measures, including denying entry or delaying a ship. This action is taken if there are clear grounds to believe the ship is not in compliance with the requirements of SOLAS Chapter XI-2 and the ISPS Code.

Q14. A plan which contains measures on board designed to protect persons on board, cargo, cargo transport units, ship stores, or the ship from the risk of a security incident is called:

- A) Emergency Towing Plan
- B) Ship Security Plan (SSP)
- C) Safety Management Manual
- D) Fire Control Plan

Correct Answer: B (Ship Security Plan (SSP))

Explanation: This definition precisely describes the purpose and scope of a Ship Security Plan (SSP) as required by the ISPS Code. The SSP outlines shipboard measures, procedures, and responsibilities for protecting against security threats to personnel, cargo,



Q15. To ensure ship's personnel are performing their security duties properly, what should be periodically executed?

- A) Engine trials
- B) On-scene security surveys/inspections
- C) Checking structural dry-dock profiles
- D) Reviewing financial accounts of the vessel

Correct Answer: B (On-scene security surveys/inspections)

Explanation: Regular on-scene security surveys, drills, and inspections are crucial to verify the effectiveness of security measures and ensure that ship's personnel are proficient in performing their assigned security duties as per the SSP. This ensures ongoing readiness and compliance.

Q16. Which shipboard personnel should be able to recognize and detect weapons, dangerous substances, and devices?

- A) Only the Master and SSO
- B) Only the deck watchkeepers
- C) All shipboard personnel
- D) The galley staff only

Correct Answer: C (All shipboard personnel)

*Explanation: Basic security awareness and the ability to recognize suspicious items or activities are fundamental for *all* shipboard personnel. This collective vigilance is critical for an effective security posture, as outlined in security training requirements to detect potential threats early.*

Q17. Security measures are *not* necessarily extended by the Contracting Governments for which type of ships/crafts?

- A) Large container vessels
- B) Fishing vessels
- C) Passenger cruise liners
- D) Chemical tankers

Correct Answer: B (Fishing vessels)

Explanation: The ISPS Code primarily applies to cargo ships of 500 GT and above, passenger ships, and mobile offshore drilling units on international voyages. Fishing vessels are generally exempt from the mandatory requirements of the ISPS Code, although some national regulations may impose similar measures.

Q18. The security assessment documentation shall be:

- A) Forwarded to the public maritime archive
- B) Kept on ship safely in a secure location
- C) Displayed publicly in the crew mess room
- D) Discarded after verification is completed

Correct Answer: B (Kept on ship safely in a secure location)

Explanation: The Ship Security Assessment (SSA) documentation, forming the basis of the SSP, contains sensitive information about vulnerabilities and threats. It must be kept secure on board the ship and with the Company, restricted to authorized personnel only, to prevent unauthorized disclosure or misuse.



- A) Local port labor trade unions
- B) IMO members
- C) Unregistered casual suppliers
- D) General cargo charterers openly

Correct Answer: B (IMO members)

Explanation: GISIS is an IMO web-based public information system that provides access to a database of information submitted by IMO Member States. While some parts are publicly accessible, detailed or restricted data is primarily for IMO Member States and authorized entities.

Q20. Ship stores are to be checked to prevent them from being accepted without inspection.

- A) Yes
- B) No

Correct Answer: A (Yes)

Explanation: Transcript reads "prevent ship stores from being accepted without inspection -> answer: yes/no check context"

Q21. Covert methods to overcome security measures include:

- A) Forcefully breaking and entering
- B) Using false documentation or hidden entries
- C) Open armed assault
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (Using false documentation or hidden entries)

Explanation: Video notes standard security breaches

Q22. The IMO resolution A.545(13) measures to prevent acts of armed robbery against ships was adopted in the year:

- A) 1975
- B) 1983
- C) 1991
- D) 2002

Correct Answer: B (1983)

Explanation: IMO Resolution A.545(13), concerning "Measures to prevent acts of piracy and armed robbery against ships," was indeed adopted in 1983. This resolution marked an early international effort to address and mitigate the rising threats of maritime security incidents.

Q23. The precise circumstances when a DoS is required by the port facility can be established through the:

- A) Chief Engineer
- B) Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO)
- C) Third Party Agent
- D) Custom Board Officer

Correct Answer: B (Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO))

Explanation: The Port Facility Security Officer (PFSO) is responsible for initiating and concluding a Declaration of Security (DoS) with the ship's SSO. The PFSO determines when a DoS is required based on prevailing security levels, specific threats, or ship-port interface conditions.



- A) Yes
- B) No

Correct Answer: A (Yes)

Explanation: An initial verification survey, conducted by the Administration or an RSO, is mandatory for every ship to confirm its compliance with SOLAS Chapter XI-2 and the ISPS Code before an International Ship Security Certificate (ISSC) can be issued for the first time.

Q25. Security equipment and systems need *not* be:

- A) Calibrated periodically
- B) Kept under lock and key at all times
- C) Maintained properly
- D) Tested during drills

Correct Answer: B (Kept under lock and key at all times)

Explanation: Should be accessible when required

Q26. What is available in the Citadel/Safe House room?

- A) Emergency means of communication
- B) Provisions
- C) Water
- D) It has all of the above

Correct Answer: D (It has all of the above)

Explanation: A Citadel or Safe Muster Point is designed as a secure refuge during pirate attacks, equipped with emergency communication, provisions (food and water), and other survival necessities to sustain the crew until rescue forces arrive. Therefore, it has all the listed items.

Q27. IMO introduced the ISPS code and made it mandatory in:

- A) January 2000
- B) July 2004
- C) December 2006
- D) June 2010

Correct Answer: B (July 2004)

Explanation: The International Ship and Port Facility Security (ISPS) Code was developed by the IMO in response to the 9/11 attacks. It became mandatory on 1 July 2004 as an amendment to SOLAS Chapter XI-2, signifying a global commitment to enhanced maritime security.

Q28. Various types of exercises with the CSO, PFSO, relevant authorities of Coast Guard, and SSO should be carried out at least once in:

- A) 3 months
- B) 6 months
- C) 12 to 18 months
- D) 24 months

Correct Answer: C (12 to 18 months)

Explanation: Security drills should be conducted at least every three months, and comprehensive security exercises involving the CSO, SSO, PFSO, and relevant authorities should be carried out at least once every 12 to 18 months. This schedule tests the full spectrum of the security plan's effectiveness.



- A) Armed robbery on the high seas
- B) Impeding safe navigation of a vessel due to close quarters engine defects
- C) Intentional boarding to capture crew hostages
- D) Seizure of cargo assets via gun threat

Correct Answer: B (Impeding safe navigation of a vessel due to close quarters engine defects)

Explanation: Piracy, by definition in UNCLOS, involves illegal acts of violence or detention committed for private ends by the crew or passengers of a private ship. Impeding navigation due to engine defects is an operational issue or accident, not an act of piracy or armed robbery.

Q30. The on-scene security survey shall fulfill the following function:

- A) Identifying the ship's navigation efficiency profiles
- B) Identifying structural vulnerabilities and access points
- C) Evaluating general propulsion parameters
- D) Overhauling mechanical safety valves

Correct Answer: B (Identifying structural vulnerabilities and access points)

Explanation: Transcript references alternate check formats

Practice Set 5

Q1. Seafarers with a designated security duty are responsible for:

- A) Deep-sea oceanographic tracking
- B) Knowledge of crowd control techniques
- C) Commercial cargo handling contracts
- D) Main propulsion optimization metrics

Correct Answer: B (Knowledge of crowd control techniques)

Explanation: Seafarers with designated security duties, such as those responsible for access control, may need knowledge of crowd control techniques, especially on passenger ships. This is essential to manage personnel flow, prevent unauthorized entry, or mitigate the escalation of security incidents effectively.

Q2. The ISPS code was brought into force by:

- A) INTERPOL
- B) IMO (International Maritime Organization)
- C) World Trade Organization
- D) International Chamber of Shipping

Correct Answer: B (IMO (International Maritime Organization))

Explanation: The International Maritime Organization (IMO), a specialized agency of the United Nations, developed and brought into force the ISPS Code. This was achieved through amendments to the SOLAS Convention to establish a comprehensive framework for enhancing maritime security globally.



- A) Yes
- B) No

Correct Answer: A (Yes)

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan (SSP) contains sensitive information regarding the ship's vulnerabilities, security measures, and response procedures. Therefore, it is classified as Sensitive Security Information (SSI) and must be protected from unauthorized disclosure, access, or modification to prevent its exploitation by malicious actors.

Q4. Security drills should be conducted at least once every:

- A) 1 month
- B) 3 months
- C) 6 months
- D) 12 months

Correct Answer: B (3 months)

Explanation: Corrected update in video audio context

Q5. The on-scene security survey shall fulfill the following function:

- A) Checking boiler water chemistry limits
- B) Evaluate monitoring of restricted areas
- C) Inspecting galley catering provisions inventory
- D) Overhauling life buoy release mechanisms

Correct Answer: B (Evaluate monitoring of restricted areas)

Explanation: The Ship Security Assessment involves identifying and evaluating critical operations, such as the monitoring of restricted areas, to ensure the Ship Security Plan (SSP) is robust. Other options relate to maintenance or administrative tasks unrelated to the fundamental security assessment objectives.

Q6. What is the advantage of an Ion Scan system?

- A) Can detect and operate in a vacuum
- B) Requires very little preparation
- C) It is portable
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: Ion Scan systems are advanced trace detection units used for identifying explosive or narcotic residue. Their advantages include high sensitivity, portability, minimal sample preparation, and the ability to operate in diverse environments, making all listed features valid.

Q7. Which of the following are regular security measures implemented at security level 1?

- A) Stop all radio communications entirely
- B) Control the embarkation of personnel and their effects
- C) Evacuate all deck positions immediately
- D) Blackout all primary deck illumination systems

Correct Answer: B (Control the embarkation of personnel and their effects)

Explanation: At Security Level 1, the minimum appropriate protective measures include controlling the embarkation of persons and their effects, such as baggage screening and identity verification. Other options describe extreme or inappropriate actions not applicable to the base security level.



- A) Only standard navigation lights
- B) All lights showing clearly the deck and surrounding the vessel
- C) No lights (Complete structural blackout)
- D) Emergency battery locker indicator lights only

Correct Answer: B (All lights showing clearly the deck and surrounding the vessel)

Explanation: Security Level 3 represents the highest security posture, typically when a security incident is imminent or occurring. Ensuring the deck and surrounding areas are fully illuminated is essential to deter intruders and monitor for unauthorized approaches.

Q9. When doing a physical search of a package or bag, we should look for the following:

- A) Brand label country codes
- B) Any visible repairs of the package or bag
- C) Retail barcode pricing layouts
- D) Color codes of wrapping strings

Correct Answer: B (Any visible repairs of the package or bag)

Explanation: Physical searches of luggage must focus on detecting tampering, such as unusual repairs, altered seams, or hidden compartments that may indicate contraband or explosive device concealment. Retail labels and bar codes are irrelevant to security threat detection.

Q10. Which of the following may be used as additional security measures?

- A) Leaving gangways unattended to decoy intruders
- B) Gratings used to block companionways
- C) Isolating fire main fire line hydrants
- D) Removing side pilot ladders during active operations

Correct Answer: B (Gratings used to block companionways)

Explanation: Additional security measures include physical barriers like gratings to restrict access to sensitive spaces like companionways. Leaving gangways unattended, isolating fire hydrants, or removing pilots during operations would severely compromise ship security and safety.

Q11. At security level 3, baggage is standardly screened on an X-ray machine from:

- A) One angle
- B) Two angles
- C) Three angles
- D) Four angles

Correct Answer: C (Three angles)

Explanation: Multi-angle X-ray screening (usually three angles) provides comprehensive images of complex items, reducing the chance that organic or metallic threats are hidden behind or within denser materials. This increases detection reliability for security-critical screenings.

Q12. After searching a suspiciously looking person, you have found nothing. What action will you take?

- A) Let them roam around the restricted compartments freely
- B) Ask the crew to keep an eye on him
- C) Hand them over to the engine workshop as a worker
- D) Detain them in a dark hold space without notification

Correct Answer: B (Ask the crew to keep an eye on him)

Explanation: If a person is suspicious, the primary objective is to maintain observation and control without escalating the situation



Q13. Security level 2 can be set for a:

- A) Indefinite prolonged duration
- B) Limited period
- C) Permanent basis for all remaining voyages
- D) Single watch hour shift only

Correct Answer: B (Limited period)

Explanation: Security Level 2 is an elevated state, typically maintained for a limited period when there is a heightened risk of a security incident. It is a temporary, proactive measure relative to changing threat assessments.

Q14. What is the best defense against pirates?

- A) Active armed counter-fire at all times
- B) Do not go to a pirate-affected area
- C) Speeding up the vessel to 40 knots
- D) Painting the hull white to blind them

Correct Answer: B (Do not go to a pirate-affected area)

Explanation: Avoiding pirate-affected areas is the most effective preventative strategy, often facilitated by AIS monitoring and compliance with Best Management Practices (BMP). Other options, like active armed fire or extreme speed, are either dangerous or impractical.

Q15. How frequently shall the Master verify the security records?

- A) Monthly
- B) Quarterly
- C) Yearly
- D) Every 5 years

Correct Answer: C (Yearly)

Explanation: Under the ISPS Code, the Master has the responsibility to ensure that security records are maintained and audited for accuracy. Periodic verification, typically on an annual basis, ensures the integrity and effectiveness of the Ship Security Plan.

Q16. What do we do with the Continuous Synopsis Record (CSR) when the flag changes?

- A) Destroy it immediately
- B) We keep them on board
- C) Mail it to the previous owner's home address
- D) Hand it over to the local port customs agents

Correct Answer: B (We keep them on board)

Explanation: The Continuous Synopsis Record (CSR) is a vital history of the ship, providing information about its status under different flags and owners. It must remain with the ship even during a change of flag, as it is a permanent legal document.

Q17. Which of the following elements shall be part of a security drill on a ship?

- A) Complete machinery breakdown overhauls
- B) Attacks from the seaward side while the ship is at berth
- C) Handling minor oil spills on deck
- D) Testing boiler safety high-pressure cut-offs

Correct Answer: B (Attacks from the seaward side while the ship is at berth)



Q18. The active security level in force shall be posted in:

- A) Only the Master's personal office cabin
- B) All common places on board the vessel
- C) Hidden inside the emergency generator room
- D) The steering flat lower deck spaces only

Correct Answer: B (All common places on board the vessel)

Explanation: The current security level must be displayed in common areas and at access points to ensure all crew and visitors are aware of their obligations. This transparency is crucial for the effective implementation of ISPS procedures.

Q19. The maritime security measures under ISPS do *not* apply to which zone?

- A) Territorial waters
- B) Continental shelf
- C) Port facilities interfacing with international vessels
- D) Internal anchorage limits

Correct Answer: B (Continental shelf)

Explanation: The ISPS Code focuses on the ship-port interface. The continental shelf is a geographical/legal definition related to resource rights and does not constitute a zone where ISPS security measures, as defined for ships and port facilities, are applied.

Q20. The SSO (Ship Security Officer) course framework was adopted by IMO resolution:

- A) 741(18)
- B) A.924(22)
- C) A.863(20)
- D) A.482(12)

Correct Answer: B (A.924(22))

Explanation: IMO Resolution A.924(22) provided the foundational framework for the development and implementation of the ISPS Code, specifically addressing the protection of ships and port facilities from unlawful acts.

Q21. On board, whose explicit duty is it to *propose* modifications to the Ship Security Plan (SSP)?

- A) The Port Authority Agent
- B) The Ship Security Officer (SSO)
- C) The Cadet on watch
- D) The Chief Cook

Correct Answer: B (The Ship Security Officer (SSO))

Explanation: The Ship Security Officer (SSO) is responsible for the day-to-day security on board and possesses the technical insight to recommend necessary updates or modifications to the Ship Security Plan to the Company Security Officer.

Q22. The modern definition of piracy includes which of the following acts?

- A) Accidental commercial short landing
- B) Shipwrecking done intentionally
- C) Minor engine machinery log discrepancies
- D) Navigating without a pilot in non-mandatory zones

Correct Answer: B (Shipwrecking done intentionally)



Q23. Which IMO resolution deals with measures to prevent unlawful acts that threaten the safety of ships and the security of passengers?

- A) 545(13)
- B) A.584(14) in 1985
- C) A.924(22)
- D) None of the above

Correct Answer: B (A.584(14) in 1985)

Explanation: IMO Resolution A.584(14) (1985) was a landmark resolution specifically focused on measures to prevent unlawful acts against the safety of ships and the security of passengers, predating and informing the later ISPS Code.

Q24. The likelihood that an unlawful act will be committed against a particular target based on a perpetrator's intent and capability is called:

- A) Vulnerability
- B) Threat
- C) Consequence
- D) Reliability index

Correct Answer: B (Threat)

Explanation: In security risk management, 'threat' is defined as the potential for an adverse event involving the combination of a perpetrator's intent and their capability to execute an attack against a target.

Q25. When using the X-ray scanning machine at an access point, the operator shall continuously monitor the screen for a maximum of:

- A) 10 minutes
- B) 20 minutes
- C) 60 minutes
- D) 120 minutes

Correct Answer: B (20 minutes)

Explanation: Due to the cognitive fatigue associated with analyzing X-ray imagery, operators are required to limit continuous screen monitoring to 20 minutes to maintain high levels of vigilance and accuracy in threat detection.

Q26. Where do we find documentation providing evidence of the Master's overriding authority regarding safety and security?

- A) In the oil record book
- B) In the Ship Security Plan (SSP)
- C) Inside the garbage log ledger
- D) In the commercial cargo charter party agreements

Correct Answer: B (In the Ship Security Plan (SSP))

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan (SSP) explicitly defines the Master's overriding authority, ensuring that the Master can take any action deemed necessary for the safety and security of the vessel, regardless of other commercial pressures.



Q27. All ship staff are *not* required to have a defined knowledge of:

- A) Basic security actions during alerts
- B) The ISPS Code in full
- C) Reporting suspicious elements to the SSO
- D) Location of emergency alarm switches

Correct Answer: B (The ISPS Code in full)

Explanation: While crew must be aware of their security roles, they are not expected to have a comprehensive, technical understanding of the entire ISPS Code. That level of in-depth knowledge is required of the SSO and CSO.

Q28. Are the Safety Officer and Security Officer always the same individual on board a ship?

- A) Yes, they must be the same rank
- B) No

Correct Answer: B (No)

Explanation: The Safety Officer (often tasked with ISM/SMS compliance) and the Ship Security Officer (tasked with ISPS/security) are distinct roles. While they can sometimes be held by the same person, it is not a requirement.

Q29. What gets absolute priority on board in case of an direct conflict between safety and security parameters?

- A) Security measures
- B) Safety of life and the vessel
- C) Cargo integrity protection
- D) Keeping to the commercial schedule

Correct Answer: B (Safety of life and the vessel)

Explanation: Under SOLAS Chapter XI-2, the safety of life and the vessel is the paramount concern. If security protocols conflict with immediate safety requirements, safety measures take absolute priority.

Q30. Areas designated as _____ in the SSP should be well marked, secured, and permit authorized entry only:

- A) Public spaces
- B) Restricted areas
- C) Recreation spaces
- D) Open decks

Correct Answer: B (Restricted areas)

Explanation: Restricted areas are defined locations on the ship where security risk is high, such as the bridge or engine room. These must be clearly marked and controlled to prevent unauthorized access per the SSP.

Practice Set 6

Q1. What does the acronym IED stand for in maritime security?

- A) Integrated Electrical Drive
- B) Improvised Explosive Device
- C) Internal Engine Damper
- D) International Enforcement Directive

Correct Answer: B (Improvised Explosive Device)

Explanation: IED stands for Improvised Explosive Device, a common term in maritime security assessments to describe



Q2. Which part of the ISPS code is fully mandatory for all signatory flag states?

- A) Part A
- B) Part B
- C) Part C
- D) Annex VI

Correct Answer: A (Part A)

Explanation: Part A of the ISPS Code contains the mandatory requirements for Contracting Governments, port authorities, and shipping companies, whereas Part B provides non-mandatory guidance for implementation.

Q3. The criteria used to decide on the physical search method of a group boarding the ship includes:

- A) The weather temperature outside
- B) The number of people
- C) The draft of the vessel at the berth
- D) The distance from the nearest city center

Correct Answer: B (The number of people)

Explanation: When planning search protocols, the scale of the operation-such as the number of people boarding-is a critical factor in determining the required resources, time, and intensity of the search procedure.

Q4. The security certificate renewal audit of a maritime vessel is done once every:

- A) 1 year
- B) 3 years
- C) 5 years
- D) 10 years

Correct Answer: C (5 years)

Explanation: The International Ship Security Certificate (ISSC) is subject to an intermediate verification and is renewed following a full audit every five years, aligning with standard SOLAS certification cycles.

Q5. Which of the following equipment is considered a part of cyber security?

- A) Mechanical tachometers
- B) Portable computer
- C) Hydraulic actuators
- D) Centrifugal fire pumps

Correct Answer: B (Portable computer)

Explanation: Cyber security concerns the protection of digital assets. Among the options, a portable computer is a key piece of IT hardware that could be a vector or target for unauthorized access, malware, or data breaches.

Q6. Emergency response services to a security incident do *not* standardly include:

- A) Armed naval backup assistance
- B) Extinguishing a major structural fire
- C) Coast Guard tactical communication support
- D) Shore medical evac links during hostage trauma

Correct Answer: B (Extinguishing a major structural fire)

Explanation: Fires come under safety/fire-fighting codes, not standard anti-security assault metrics Fires are managed under safety frameworks



- A) Calibrating engine indicators precisely
- B) Knowledge of methods of physical searches of ship stores
- C) Overseeing dry dock budget balances
- D) Operating commercial crane systems ashore

Correct Answer: B (Knowledge of methods of physical searches of ship stores)

Explanation: Seafarers with designated security duties must be trained to identify and assist in security tasks, including the physical search of stores, baggage, and other items to prevent the carriage of illicit goods.

Q8. What percentage of baggage is required to be checked at standard Security Level 1?

- A) 100% manually without exception
- B) As per the parameters specified in the Ship Security Plan (SSP)
- C) 0% checked unless authorized by local police
- D) 50% checked by alternate lottery method

Correct Answer: B (As per the parameters specified in the Ship Security Plan (SSP))

Explanation: The exact percentage of baggage to be screened is determined by the specific requirements laid out in the Ship Security Plan (SSP), which must account for the current security level and vessel-specific risk assessment.

Q9. PMSCs (Private Maritime Security Companies) should require that their personnel do not use firearms against persons except in _____ or defense of others:

- A) Clearing path ways
- B) Self-defense
- C) Warnings during routine approach
- D) Checking identification criteria

Correct Answer: B (Self-defense)

Explanation: The use of firearms by private security is strictly governed by the principles of necessity and proportionality, limiting their use solely to self-defense or the defense of others to prevent loss of life.

Q10. As per the ISPS code, a ship is required to maintain records of its past:

- A) 5 ports of call
- B) 10 ports of call
- C) 15 ports of call
- D) 20 ports of call

Correct Answer: B (10 ports of call)

Explanation: The ISPS Code mandates that vessels maintain records of the past 10 ports of call, which is essential for tracking the security history and ensuring the ship has followed appropriate security measures at every terminal.

Q11. The crew is required to know which of the following during an emergency?

- A) Location and use of emergency equipment
- B) Casualty handling
- C) Being aware not to use elevators in an emergency
- D) All of the above

Correct Answer: D (All of the above)

Explanation: All crew members must have a foundational understanding of emergency procedures, including the location of equipment, basic casualty care, and the dangers of using elevators during emergencies, to ensure safe evacuation.



- A) Flat tabletop spaces
- B) Hollow out moldings
- C) Open hanging coat rack pegs
- D) Exposed bathroom tile surfaces

Correct Answer: B (Hollow out moldings)

Explanation: Hidden storage spaces, such as behind interior moldings or in false bulkheads, are classic areas where contraband is concealed. These areas are priority targets during cabin security searches.

Q13. Which of the following poses an active potential security risk to the ship's networks?

- A) Routine weather fax printouts
- B) Emails attempting to obtain sensitive information regarding the vessel (Phishing)
- C) Standard radar tuning alerts
- D) VHF channel 16 routine calls

Correct Answer: B (Emails attempting to obtain sensitive information regarding the vessel (Phishing))

Explanation: Phishing emails are a primary method of cyber-attack, designed to trick personnel into revealing sensitive vessel information or credentials, which could lead to a breach of the ship's security systems.

Q14. Is it necessary to issue a visitor ID token to whoever comes on the vessel and collect it back when they leave?

- A) Yes
- B) No

Correct Answer: A (Yes)

Explanation: Yes, visitor ID management is a core requirement of access control. Issuing and collecting tokens ensures that the ship maintains a precise record of all unauthorized personnel currently on board.

Q15. Who is responsible for submitting the Ship Security Plan for official administration approval?

- A) Ship Security Officer (SSO)
- B) Company Security Officer (CSO)
- C) Third Engineer
- D) The Chief Mate

Correct Answer: B (Company Security Officer (CSO))

Explanation: The Company Security Officer (CSO) is the designated person ashore responsible for liaising with the flag state or Recognized Security Organization (RSO) to ensure the SSP meets regulatory standards and gains official approval.

Q16. Who addresses and deals directly with any identified structural deficiencies or non-conformities of security measures on behalf of the management?

- A) The Port Customs Clearance Team
- B) Company Security Officer (CSO)
- C) The Supplier's Delivery Foreman
- D) Junior Engineer on duty

Correct Answer: B (Company Security Officer (CSO))

Explanation: The Company Security Officer (CSO) is the bridge between the vessel and the company management, responsible for addressing non-conformities and ensuring that security infrastructure and protocols are properly maintained.



Q17. When doing a physical search of a package or a bag, we should look for the following:

- A) The retail barcode design structure
- B) Unusual electronic appliances hidden within standard spaces
- C) Country of manufacture stamp marks
- D) Weight labels on the exterior print

Correct Answer: B (Unusual electronic appliances hidden within standard spaces)

Explanation: During a physical search, one must be vigilant for anomalies such as unusual weight, strange noises, or electronic components-like wires or sensors-hidden in packages, which may indicate the presence of illicit items or dangerous goods.

Q18. The Ship Security Plan (SSP) cannot be shown to any unauthorized person without the approval of:

- A) The Master, SSO, or CSO
- B) Any crew member on watch duty
- C) The local ship supplier foreman
- D) The terminal cargo operations loader

Correct Answer: A (The Master, SSO, or CSO)

Explanation: The Ship Security Plan is a restricted document containing sensitive vulnerability data. Access to it is strictly controlled and limited to authorized personnel like the Master, SSO, and CSO to prevent information leakage.

Q19. During container loading, which of the following is required at Security Level 1?

- A) Checking 100% interior contents of all sealed boxes
- B) Checking of loading as per the loading plan
- C) Discharging all other auxiliary fuel oils
- D) Complete lockdown of all steering machinery positions

Correct Answer: B (Checking of loading as per the loading plan)

Explanation: At Security Level 1, verifying the cargo against the loading plan is the standard security measure. This ensures the cargo matches the documentation and helps prevent the unauthorized loading of dangerous or illicit items.

Q20. You find a suspicious object on the deck. Which initial action will you take to safeguard life?

- A) Carry it manually to the captain's office deck
- B) Move all personnel as far away from the object as possible
- C) Submerge it in the main galley sink water tank immediately
- D) Hit it with a wrench to check for metallic hollow signatures

Correct Answer: B (Move all personnel as far away from the object as possible)

Explanation: In the event of a suspicious object, the primary goal is the safety of the crew. Evacuation and cordoning off the area are the mandatory initial responses, followed by professional intervention; the object should never be touched or moved.